

Glossary

abolition The act of doing away with something completely.

allies/allied forces People or countries working together. In World War I and World War II, the Allied forces were the countries fighting against Germany.

anti-Semitism Prejudice and hostility toward Jewish people.

Axis powers Nations on Germany's side in World War II, including Italy and Japan.

BCE Before Common Era. The years before 1 CE (Common Era). This abbreviation has replaced BC (Before Christ).

Bronze Age A period of ancient history when people mostly used bronze for making tools and weapons.

caliph The title of a political and religious leader of an Islamic empire, or caliphate.

capitalism An economic system based on private ownership of property and competitive conditions for business.

casualties People killed or injured as a result of war or an accident.

cavalry Military troops mounted on horseback.

CE Common Era. The years from 1 CE to the present day. This abbreviation has replaced AD (Anno Domini, which is Latin for "in the year of our Lord").

citizen A person who belongs to a city or a bigger community such as a state or country.

city-state A city, and its surrounding territory, that has its own independent government.

civil rights The rights of citizens to be socially and politically equal.

civil service All the government departments and employees of a country or state, not including the armed forces.

civil war A war between opposing groups of people in the same country.

civilization The culture and way of life of people living together in an organized and developed society.

colonization The act of sending settlers to establish a colony in another country, sometimes involving taking political control over the people already living there.

colony An area under the political control of another state; or the group of people who have settled there.

communism The political belief in a society in which ownership of property and wealth is shared.

constitution A set of laws that determines the political principles of a government.

culture The customs, beliefs, and behavior shared by a society.

dictator A leader who rules a country alone, with no restrictions on the extent of their power.

dynasty A royal family ruling a country for successive generations.

economy The system through which goods and services are produced, sold, and bought in a country or state.

empire A group of lands or peoples brought under the rule of one government or person.

epidemic A sudden spread of a disease within a specific region.

fascism A political movement stressing nationalism, which places the strength of the state above individual citizens' welfare.

feudal system A social system that developed in medieval Europe and Japan, in which lords granted land to people of lower rank in return for loyalty, military assistance, and services.

golden age A period of great success, development, or achievement.

guerrilla warfare A type of warfare in which small groups of fighters, who are not part of regular uniformed armies, make use of sabotage and surprise attacks against a larger force.

hominin A member of the biological group that includes humans and their extinct relatives.

Ice Age A period when global temperatures drop drastically and large areas become covered by vast sheets of ice. There have been at least five ice ages in Earth's history.

Indigenous When applied to people, the word indigenous describes the original settlers of a country or region.